

- Nominee name

Kaydence Paff

- Nominee year of graduation

2027

- How many years the student has participated in FIRST

4 years (1 year FLL and 3 years FRC)

1. Explain how the student embodies the philosophies of Gracious Professionalism® and Coopertition® through the FIRST Core Values: Discovery, Innovation, Impact, Inclusion, Teamwork and Fun. Please provide examples. 771 out of 800

Friend. Support. Voice of Reason. These are just a few things people say about Kaydence Paff. She embodies the spirit and ethos of *FIRST*. Kaydence sets an example for her teammates with her dedication to learning, problem solving, and openness to accept all as they are. She shares her *FIRST* experiences and knowledge with her teammates, classmates and beyond. Her stories about being a part of *FIRST* robotics inspire others to join *FIRST* teams and attend STEM outreach events. She has built partnerships with her teammates steeped in mutual trust, collaboration, and fun. Kaydence works diligently on her tasks as well as continually ensuring her teammates' success. Her efforts as a part of Team 1091 have made an impact on the team, her classmates, and the community.

2. How has the student increased the awareness of FIRST? Describe the student's interests and/or plans to continue to engage with FIRST beyond high school. Please provide examples. 771 out of 800

Kaydence shares her *FIRST* experience and knowledge not only with teammates but with those in her classes and clubs outside of robotics. Her stories about Team 1091 inspired 5 classmates to join the team the past 2 seasons; accounting for **31% of new members**. She leads the team in recruitment by a wide margin. Also, her personal invites to the team's 2nd annual Galentine's Women in STEM event accounted for 50% of the event's attendance. By sharing her FLL experience, she inspired **six 5th graders to join FLL** for the UNEARTHED season. Finally, Kaydence's idea to change the focus of the Youth Programming Camp increased youth interest that led to a **75% increase in camp**

attendance from previous years. In the future, she plans to continue as both an FLL and FRC mentor.

3. How does the student's individual contribution to the team benefit the team as a whole? Please provide examples. 798 out of 800

Team 1091 benefits from Kaydence's contributions to outreach planning, safety, recruitment, and *FIRST* promotion. Her efforts planning the team's youth programming camp increased attendance **75%**. When she sees a problem, she looks for ways to come together and address the issue. Our team's mascot was overheating and struggling with mobility issues. She formed a group to develop solutions. They created a mascot manual to provide guidelines that improved the safety of those in the costume. The new 30-minute time limit has been the most impactful; people no longer exit the costume drenched in sweat and red faced. Also, through her everyday sharing of her *FIRST* experiences, she contributed to the team's sustainability by recruiting **an FLL team and 31% of our team's new members from 2024-2026**.

4. Describe the student's experience in and mastery of areas of STEM. This could include, but is not limited to, skills in engineering, software, CAD, fabrication, etc. Please provide examples. 709 out of 800

Kaydence's skills and experience are in computer programming and graphic design. She has taken courses in Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, website design, computer programming (HTML, Python, JavaScript), and photography. Since 2024, she has taught **69% of new members** and **41% of the overall team** how to use Adobe Illustrator.

Kaydence's graphic design skills make her the go-to person when the team needs a poster, graphic, or flyer. Beginning in 2025, she began assisting the programming team with website computer updates. She also planned and instructed the HTML portion of the 2025 Youth Programming Camp. In addition, Kaydence is using her programming skills to plan and implement a new youth STEM workshop.

5. Explain the student's leadership to their fellow team members and/or others in the community. How do they motivate others? What is their leadership style? Please provide examples. 788 out of 800

In 2025-26, Kaydence leads as our Business Lead, Youth Programming Camp co-lead, and FLL Junior Mentor. Her leadership style is a blend of collaborative and servant styles. She is supportive and works alongside others to help them achieve and foster partnerships. When Kaydence engages in conversations, she actively listens and responds with encouraging words and thoughtful questions. She learns about others and finds shared interests to connect on a personal level. Kaydence champions everyone. She treats everyone with respect and compassion. She locates the fun in each task and motivates others by highlighting areas that interest them. Everyone shares with her because they trust her not to judge or dismiss them. Kaydence demonstrates that a leader can also be a good teammate.

Additionally, there is a 500-character limit prompt for sharing additional information about the student:

6. Please share anything else you'd like us to know about the student, including academic performance, specialized skills, technical expertise, or additional extracurricular activities. 495 out of 500

In school, Kaydence's coursework includes AP Computer Science Principles, AP Biology, and Ap Psychology. Outside of Robotics, she has participated in Girl Scouts for over 10 years. To date she has earned her Bronze and Silver Awards and is working towards the Gold Award. Also, she has been a scout day camp counselor for 4 years; where she plans and leads activities. Kaydence is also the president of the school Magic the Gathering Club (2 yrs) and a member of the school E-Sports team (1 yr).